WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital

POLAND

Europe

Information current as of November 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Warsaw and Mazovia	Capital and largest economy; seat of government, the National Bank of Poland, the Warsaw Stock Exchange and most regional headquarters	Financial and business services, IT, defence procurement, real estate
Central Poland (CPK airport and rail hub)	Planned new central airport for Warsaw, linked to a nationwide high-speed rail network and targeting opening in 2032	Construction, engineering, rail systems, aviation services
Pomerania (Gdańsk, Gdynia, Lubiatowo-Kopalino)	Baltic ports, the site of Poland's first nuclear power plant and the landfall for offshore wind farms	Energy, offshore wind supply chain, port logistics, shipbuilding
Kraków and Lesser Poland	Major university city and a leading centre for shared services and technology investment	Business services, software, life sciences, R&D
Wrocław and Lower Silesia	Western manufacturing cluster close to Germany and Czechia, strong in electromobility and batteries	Automotive, batteries, electronics, logistics
Upper Silesia (Katowice)	Traditional industrial heartland undergoing energy transition, with deep engineering skills	Advanced manufacturing, automotive, energy transition projects
Rzeszów and the eastern border	Eastern aerospace and manufacturing centre and the main logistics gateway to Ukraine	Aerospace, defence, logistics, Ukraine reconstruction supply

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Polish Investment and Trade Agency (PAIH) provides free investor support; it finalised 64 projects worth more than €4 billion with 6,600 new jobs in 2025
- Polish Investment Zone: support decisions grant corporate income tax exemptions for new investments anywhere in Poland, currently for 10–15 years; a draft amendment would extend this to 15–20 years from 2027
- Corporate income tax of 19%, with a 9% rate for small taxpayers with revenue up to the equivalent of €2 million
- EU single-market and Schengen membership, with free movement of capital under EU rules; the złoty floats freely and Poland is not in the euro area
- EU co-financing through the €54.7 billion National Recovery Plan (KPO) and cohesion programmes for energy, transport and digital projects

- Defence-sector entry through the €43.7 billion EU SAFE loan programme, with the government planning to spend 89% of the funds in Poland
- Large-project tenders from state developers such as Polskie Elektrownie Jądrowe (nuclear) and the CPK central airport and rail company

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Poland in November 2026 is the EU's largest and most consistent growth story in Central Europe, combining a large domestic market with full access to the single market. GDP grew 3.6% in 2025 and 3.9% year-on-year in the second quarter of 2026, among the fastest rates in the EU. Inflation eased to 3.5% in October 2026, within the central bank's 2.5% ±1 point target band, and the National Bank of Poland has held its reference rate at 3.75%, the lowest since 2022, for seven consecutive meetings. Foreign direct investment inflows reached PLN 65.5 billion in 2025, 2.6% higher than in 2024, led by reinvested earnings that show established investors are expanding. Very large programmes are now under way: Poland signed the EU's first SAFE defence loan for €43.7 billion in May 2026, the 1.1 GW Baltic Power offshore wind farm delivered first power in July 2026, and the European Commission has approved state aid for the first nuclear plant, a project of about €42 billion.

Poland's main structural challenge is public finances. The general government deficit reached 7.3% of GDP in 2025, the second highest in the EU, and the draft 2027 budget keeps it at 7.1%, reflecting defence spending of 4.5% of GDP alongside higher health and social spending. Public debt passed 60% of GDP in June 2026, and Moody's lowered its rating to A3 with a stable outlook in September 2026, citing fiscal strength and political constraints before the November 2027 election. The starting point remains sound: debt of 59.7% of GDP in 2025 was well below the EU average of 81.7%, growth is strong, and the EU excessive deficit procedure sets a path to bring the deficit below 3% by 2028. For investors, the spending is itself an opportunity, channelling large sums into defence, energy security and transport through transparent tenders.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
High fiscal deficit and rising debt	The deficit was 7.3% of GDP in 2025 and is planned at 7.1% in 2027; Moody's cut the rating to A3 in September 2026	Debt remains below the EU average and the EU deficit procedure anchors consolidation; model possible tax changes after the 2027 election
Political cohabitation	Frequent presidential vetoes by President Karol Nawrocki, including on the SAFE implementing law, slow some legislation	The government has used alternative routes, as with the SAFE agreement; track the November 2027 parliamentary election
Currency exposure	Poland is outside the euro area, so złoty movements affect returns and euro-denominated costs	Use hedging and natural hedges such as local-currency revenue; deep local capital markets support financing in złoty
Tax and incentive changes	Special economic zones end on 31 December 2026 and the Polish Investment Zone rules are being amended	Apply for support decisions with PAIH early and take local tax advice on the 2027 rules
Labour and wage costs	Wage growth of about 6% a year and skills shortages raise costs in major cities	Locate in regional university centres and use automation, which the draft incentive rules will support
Delivery risk on mega-projects	Nuclear, airport and rail projects are large and complex, with long timelines	State aid approvals, EU funding and state guarantees support delivery; position as a supplier or subcontractor early
Proximity to the war in Ukraine	Poland borders Ukraine, Belarus and Russia's Kaliningrad region	As a NATO and EU member spending 4.5% of GDP on defence, Poland is well protected; include routine security planning

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Poland's risk profile is that of a large, diversified EU economy with strong growth, a flexible exchange rate and a sound banking system. It is not on the FATF grey list and is rated investment grade by all three major agencies,

with Moody's at A3 stable following its September 2026 downgrade. The main issues are the fiscal deficit, now under an EU excessive deficit procedure with a 2028 target, and political cohabitation between Prime Minister Donald Tusk's government and President Karol Nawrocki, which has slowed some laws ahead of the November 2027 parliamentary election. Both are manageable: debt is below the EU average and the government has kept major programmes such as SAFE on track. Poland borders Ukraine, Belarus and Russia; EU sanctions on Russia and Belarus apply in full, so cross-border trade with those two countries requires sanctions screening. For most investors Poland offers the legal certainty of EU law and a fast-growing domestic market.

MARKET ACCESS

As an EU member, Poland gives investors tariff-free access to the EU single market of some 450 million people and to all EU free trade agreements, with trade with third countries governed by the EU's common trade policy and WTO rules. Poland is a central link in European manufacturing supply chains, particularly with Germany. Schengen membership allows passport-free movement across most of the EU. Poland sits on the main east–west corridor between Germany and Ukraine and on the north–south route from the Baltic to the Adriatic, with Baltic ports at Gdańsk, Gdynia and Szczecin–Świnoujście. It is also the main logistics hub for supplies to Ukraine and is expected to play a leading role in reconstruction.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Chancellery of the Prime Minister (Prime Minister Donald Tusk)	Sets economic, fiscal, defence and EU policy for the pro-EU coalition government	Primary reference point for Poland's strategic direction and major projects
Polish Investment and Trade Agency (PAIH)	National investment agency handling foreign investors, incentives and site selection	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentives
National Bank of Poland (NBP)	Central bank setting the reference rate, held at 3.75% in November 2026, and managing the złoty	Relevant for monetary outlook, currency and banking matters
Ministry of Finance and Economy (Minister Andrzej Domański)	Leads the budget, tax policy, the excessive deficit procedure and the Polish Investment Zone rules	Key counterpart on tax, incentives and public finance
Ministry of National Defence (Minister Władysław Kosiniak-Kamysz)	Manages defence spending of 4.5% of GDP and SAFE-funded procurement	Counterpart for defence manufacturers and suppliers
Polskie Elektrownie Jądrowe (PEJ)	State company building the first nuclear plant with Westinghouse AP1000 reactors	Counterpart for nuclear supply-chain and construction partners
Centralny Port Komunikacyjny (CPK)	State company developing the new central airport and high-speed rail network	Counterpart for construction, engineering and rail-systems tenders

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce in Poland, the British Polish Chamber of Commerce, the Polish-German Chamber of Industry and Commerce and the Polish Chamber of Commerce are the main business associations, with sector committees and regular dialogue with government. PAIH runs investor services and promotes Poland abroad, and its annual investor awards highlight leading projects. Bank Gospodarstwa Krajowego, the state development bank, and the Polish Development Fund (PFR) co-finance projects and channel National Recovery Plan funds. The European Bank for Reconstruction and Development, the European Investment Bank and the World Bank are active in energy, infrastructure and private-sector finance.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Poland suits investors seeking scale and growth inside the EU: manufacturers serving German and European supply chains from Lower Silesia, Silesia and Wielkopolska; technology and business-services firms drawing on large talent pools in Kraków, Warsaw and Wrocław; energy investors targeting nuclear, offshore wind, grids and storage; defence and security companies positioned for SAFE-funded procurement; and infrastructure and

construction groups bidding for airport, rail and port projects. Investors preparing for Ukraine's reconstruction can use Poland as an EU-based logistics and manufacturing platform.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage PAIH and secure a Polish Investment Zone decision
Open dialogue with the agency on site selection and apply early for a support decision, taking account of the rule changes due from 2027.

STEP 2: Position for major state tenders
Register with PEJ, CPK and defence procurement bodies and identify partners for nuclear, rail, airport and SAFE-funded contracts.

STEP 3: Map EU and development-bank funding
Identify National Recovery Plan, cohesion and development-bank co-financing for energy, digital and infrastructure components.

STEP 4: Plan for fiscal and currency developments
Track the 2027 budget and deficit procedure, model złoty exposure and build hedging into financial plans.

STEP 5: Prepare a Ukraine-facing strategy
Assess Poland's eastern border region as a base for reconstruction supply, screening any eastward trade against EU sanctions.